

A8R32-MVP Deluxe

The last of the (939) Mohicans

The A8R32-MVP Deluxe is Asus' implementation of ATI's much-acclaimed, enthusiast-grade RD580 Northbridge-based chipset. This is a dual-chip solution unlike the nForce 4 series. The Southbridge is based on ULI's M1575 chipset.

Catering to the fastest Socket 939 AMD dual-cores, the A8R features support for dual x16 CrossFire gaming. Four DIMMs allow a maximum of 4 GB of memory, dual-channel. The lack of integrated graphics and its four-phase design bolsters the board's gaming identity!

Build quality is excellent. It doesn't have a heat-pipe like nForce 4 SLI 32-based boards, but the chipset hardly ever heats up enough to justify one anyway.

The A8R can easily accommodate two dual-slot graphics cards in its PCI-Express slots. With a single graphics card, at least two of the PCI slots are still usable. The 24-pin motherboard power slot and the PATA slot are placed rather close to each other, though. Sufficient space has been provided between the individual memory slots and between the CPU region and the memory slots.

The BIOS brims with numerous overclocking and tweaking options—the FSB can be tweaked in increments of 1 MHz all the way to 300 MHz. The BIOS also allows you to tweak the voltages of the Northbridge components by 0.1 V; these components include the core power, the HT bus, and the PCI-Express bus. CPU voltage fine-tuning is allowed, with adjustments of 0.025 V at a time.

Features-wise, with six SATA 2 ports, external SATA, two onboard LAN controllers, two full 8 GBps PCI-Express slots

in addition to three PCI and two PCI-Express x1 slots, the A8R will keep you future-proof for quite some time. FireWire and coaxial audio-outs have also been provided. Asus provides a mean bundle with this board, including three add-on PCI cards, and four SATA connectors, among others.

When it comes to performance, the A8R holds it own with some great scores across the board. 3D Mark 06 showed a score of over 7000!

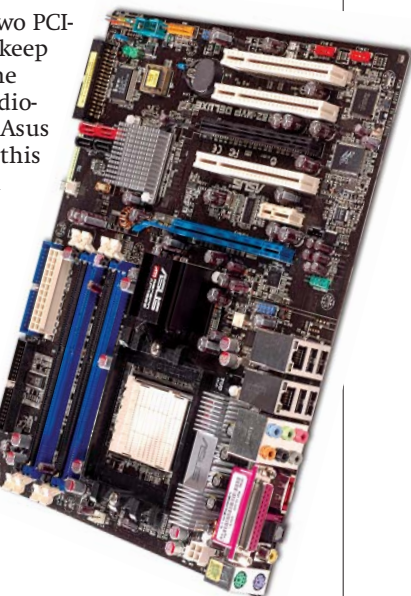
At Rs 14,000 plus taxes, the A8R MVP 32 Deluxe certainly isn't cheap. If you have/want a fast Socket 939 processor this motherboard should be right up your alley.

Specifications

ATI RD580 Northbridge, ULI M1575 Southbridge, dual x16 PCI-Express slots (CrossFire-ready), 3 PCI slots, 1 PCI-Express x1 slot, dual LAN, 7.1-channel audio with S/PDIF and coaxial outs

RATINGS

Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Package contents	★★★★★
Value for money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★



Contact: AsusTek Computer

Phone: 022-40058923

E-mail: media_india@asus.com

Web site: www.asus.com.tw

Price: Rs 14,000

BLH-1200 Bluetooth stereo headset

Not quite the audiophile's phones



Almost every PC peripheral is going Bluetooth—mouse, keyboard, or headset. LevelOne's BLH-1200 is a Bluetooth headset that promises to work with any music device or cell phone. The bundle consists of a pair of headphones and a USB dongle.

The headset sports an articulated design and folds into a small package—the folding joints ooze quality. The padding on the headset feels comfortable; however, the small size of the cans means external noise isn't effectively sealed.

The USB dongle has a 180 degree-moveable 3.5 mm jack that allows connection to CE devices and streaming of music over Bluetooth. Driver installation is required for using the dongle with a PC, and the provided applications stream music to the headset. If you are on Skype, for example, wireless communication with your PC is made possible using the headset-dongle combo.

We paired the headset with a few cell phones—a Nokia E61, a Nokia 6630 and a Sony Ericsson W800i, for music. The pairing was a no-brainer; we were able to stream music from the phones, except for the W800i, which only supports a headset profile. The pairing is good for at least 10 feet—after which quality starts degrading.

We used the headset for voice communication, and

it performed appreciably well. Where voice quality is concerned, reception was great, and the microphone does a good job, too. When the headset was used along with the dongle for listening to music, the range was slightly better than when it was used with the cell phones.

The headphones streamed music for four and a half hours on a full charge. All very well, but they still leave a lot to be desired when it comes to actual music quality. At Rs 5,095 (MRP), we felt that the price was somewhat high given the sound quality, but as a decent Bluetooth headset for cell phones, we have no gripes.

Contact: LevelOne

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Web site: www.level1.co.in

Price: Rs 5,095

RATINGS

Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Package contents	★★★★★
Value for money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★